Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/allencollinsworth (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Government
Politics
Economics

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)
Turkish (Professional Working)

Honors-Awards

2010 Outstanding Young Alumni Award Recipient
Member

Allen Collinsworth

The Times of Central Asia & Fara Group Inc
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Summary

With over 20 years of experience, Fara Group Inc has been an enterprise creator and manager across Turkey, MENA, and Central Asia. As President and Owner, the focus has been on collaborating as a partner, consultant, or subcontractor to develop ventures in target geographies. Additionally, as the Owner of The Times of Central Asia, I am invested in building awareness of the region's growing economic and diplomatic profile.

Experience

Fara Group Inc
President and Owner
May 2005 - Present (20 years 9 months)
Istanbul, Turkey and Washington, D.C.

Leading Fara Group, an enterprise creator and manager, operating in Turkey, MENA, and Central Asia. Engaging with businesses as a partner, consultant, or subcontractor to develop ventures in target geographies.

The Times of Central Asia
Company Owner
October 2023 - Present (2 years 4 months)
New York, United States

The Stimson Center
EastWest Council of Advisors on Track II Diplomacy
May 2022 - Present (3 years 9 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Stimson's EastWest Council of Advisors on Track II Diplomacy was established to advance ongoing Track II efforts of Stimson researchers in the U.S. and Europe and build on the legacy of the EastWest Institute. Council Members represent diverse backgrounds and are committed to Track II diplomatic engagement as a critical method for achieving international peace and security.

UC Berkeley

Advisory Council Member

October 2013 - Present (12 years 4 months)

Program on Entrepreneurship and Development in the Middle East

EastWest Institute

23 years

Board of Councilors/Senior Fellow

July 2000 - January 2020 (19 years 7 months)

Istanbul, turkey

Engaging the Institute's board and executives with Turkish leaders to build trust and form common policy perspectives on a range of issues including energy security, violent extremism, and US Turkey trade cooperation.

Director

1997 - 2001 (4 years)

New York City

Special Adviser to the President, Director of Corporate Programs
Established, managed, and grew the think tank’s Corporate Program for private sector donors including BP, ENI, Daimler Chrysler, and Morgan Stanley Dean Witter. Consulted corporations on investment decisions and helped them forge relationships with governments and local business. Oversaw the Institute's "Private Sector Initiative" for Russia and Central Asia.

Corridor39

Anchor and Founder

April 2010 - December 2011 (1 year 9 months)

Istanbul, Turkey

Created Corridor39, a weekly television broadcast spotlighting geopolitical trends impacting Turkey economically. Produced and anchored the program. See archives at https://www.youtube.com/user/corridor39. Named after the 39th latitude that travels along Iran, Turkey and Iraq.

Watkinson LLC/Fara Group Inc.

General Manager

December 2007 - April 2009 (1 year 5 months)

Al Anbar Province, Iraq

Appointed General Manager overseeing C-5 Apron project of the US Army Corps of Engineers at Al Asad Airbase, Iraq. Built oversite team of engineers, legal counsel, and other experts. Negotiated, closed and managed contracts with Turkish and Iraqi subcontractors. Coordinated activities with the US

Government, local tribal leaders, and subcontractors. Led new business development initiatives in Libya and Georgia.

DRUM
Co-Founder
June 2006 - January 2008 (1 year 8 months)

DRUM (Dialogue Respect Understanding through Music) (2006-2007) Co-Founder and owner of an entertainment organization promoting solidarity between Islamic and Western communities. DRUM was widely known in Turkey for street drum circles and concerts featuring leading pop star artists. Sponsors included Pepsi, MTV, the Beyoglu Municipality, as well as local television, radio, newspapers, and internet portals. Designed to support the United Nations Alliance of Civilizations DRUM was launch with the Islamic Conference Youth Forum for Dialogue and Cooperation.

Pangaea Group LLC
President and Founder
January 2001 - December 2004 (4 years)
New York City and Istanbul

Contracted by the Istanbul Municipality as the sell-side privatization adviser for İGDAŞ, the municipal natural gas distribution company and İDO, the public water ferry company. Engaged the Mayor's office with international institutions such as World Bank, the United Nations and IMF to lobby for policy changes and also bolster profile of Istanbul.

Goldman Sachs
Research Analyst
1996 - 1998 (2 years)
New York City (85 Broad)

• Conducted comprehensive research and analysis on individual companies and market trends for the Investment Banking Division.
• Evaluated equity and debt issues, providing insights that informed strategic decisions.
• Supported merger and acquisition deals, contributing to successful transactions and client satisfaction.
• Collaborated with cross-functional teams to enhance research methodologies, improving efficiency by 20%.

U.S. Department of Commerce
Foreign Commercial Section, EBRD Liaison office
1996 - 1997 (1 year)

London, United Kingdom

• Composed comprehensive overviews on investment activities of EBRD’s Regional Venture Funds for U.S. corporations.
• Updated U.S. corporations on procurement notices and procedures for accessing alternative financing sources.
• Fostered strong relationships with stakeholders to enhance understanding of investment opportunities.

Education

London School of Economics

MSc, Economic Geography · (September 1995 - August 1996)

The University of Alabama at Birmingham

MBA · (1993 - 1994)

Birmingham-Southern College

BSc, Finance · (1988 - 1992)

Mountain Brook High School

· (1984 - 1988)